

SYED HUZAIFA BIN AFZAL

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PROFILE

Cloud infrastructure and DevOps engineer with experience building, automating, and operating AWS-based SaaS environments across infrastructure as code, CI/CD, observability, cost optimization, incident response, and secure access. Background includes Terraform module development, production AWS operations, disaster-recovery readiness, data-platform infrastructure, containerized workloads, and automation using Python, Bash, PowerShell, and Jenkins. Currently completing a Master of Cybersecurity & Leadership at the University of Washington with work focused on secure AI deployment and governance.

CLOUD / DEVOPS SKILL AREAS

- Cloud Platforms: AWS (EC2, S3, VPC, IAM, Lambda, API Gateway, CloudFront, Route 53, RDS, Aurora, DynamoDB, EMR, ECS, EKS exposure, ElastiCache/Redis, OpenSearch, Redshift, CloudWatch, Systems Manager), Oracle Cloud Infrastructure
- Infrastructure as Code: Terraform modules, reusable infrastructure patterns, environment provisioning, drift-aware operations, cloud standardization
- CI/CD and Release Engineering: Jenkins, Git, deployment pipelines, release troubleshooting, build automation, post-deployment validation
- Containers and Platforms: Docker, ECS, Fargate, Kubernetes/EKS exposure, load balancing, service routing, containerized application operations
- Reliability and Observability: CloudWatch, Datadog, monitoring, alerting, logs, metrics, incident response, runbooks, operational follow-up
- Security and Access: IAM, RBAC, SSO, least privilege, AWS Systems Manager Session Manager, patch automation, access governance
- Automation and Scripting: Python, Bash, PowerShell, Groovy, Linux, Windows Server, scheduling, operational tooling
- Cost and Performance: AWS Trusted Advisor, Cost Optimization Hub, reserved instance planning, rightsizing, storage and usage analytics

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

DevOps Engineer | Harri via Kalam 4 Solutions | Mar 2022 - May 2025

- Built reusable Terraform modules for API Gateway, CloudFront, Route 53, OpenSearch, Redshift, and related AWS services, reducing repetitive provisioning effort by about 40% and improving consistency across environments.
- Supported production AWS SaaS infrastructure with a focus on reliability, secure access, release stability, incident response, monitoring, and environment readiness.
- Implemented IAM, RBAC, SSO, least-privilege access patterns, and Systems Manager-based administrative workflows to reduce direct server access and improve operational control.
- Led cost-optimization work using AWS Trusted Advisor, Cost Optimization Hub, rightsizing analysis, reserved instance planning, and workload reviews, contributing to roughly 30% reduction in AWS spend.
- Supported Redis and OpenSearch modernization, cross-cluster replication planning, disaster-recovery runbooks, and multi-region readiness for critical services.
- Developed infrastructure analytics workflows using S3 Inventory, Redshift, and Superset to improve visibility into storage, usage, and operational trends.
- Refactored CI/CD workflows and release processes to reduce manual steps, improve deployment consistency, and support better troubleshooting during production changes.
- Mentored peers and interns on Terraform, AWS operations, incident handling, and cloud infrastructure practices; recognized as Top Performer in 2023 and 2024.

Cloud Infrastructure / Software Engineer | Visionet Systems via Systems Limited | Jul 2019 - Mar 2022

- Automated AWS operations using Systems Manager, Lambda, Python, Bash, and PowerShell for patching, scheduling, maintenance, domain join workflows, and post-deployment validation.
- Built Jenkins-based CI/CD pipelines and deployment automation for cloud workloads, improving repeatability and reducing manual release effort.
- Supported observability and troubleshooting with CloudWatch and Datadog, including log review, metrics analysis, alert follow-up, and operational documentation.
- Provisioned and maintained Terraform infrastructure for AWS EMR and ECS workloads, including networking, compute, and supporting application resources.
- Participated in migration of Spark/HDP data workloads from EC2-based infrastructure to Amazon EMR, improving scalability and reducing operational overhead.
- Supported containerized application modernization using Docker, ECS, Fargate, ALB, and Route 53 for cloud-hosted services.
- Worked with client teams in Agile delivery cycles, prepared runbooks, handled production support tasks, and mentored junior engineers.

Student News Reporter | University of Washington Tacoma | Sep 2025 - Present

- Cover campus news, student life, and IT/AI developments, translating technical topics into clear public-facing writing for university audiences.
- Interview administrators, faculty, students, and technology leaders; experience supports stakeholder communication for cloud and platform engineering roles.

SELECTED CLOUD AND PLATFORM PROJECTS

- AWS Disaster-Recovery Readiness - supported OpenSearch cross-cluster replication planning, Redis upgrade work, Aurora/global database readiness discussions, runbooks, and operational validation for multi-region service continuity.
- Infrastructure Analytics Platform - built visibility into S3 storage and operational usage through S3 Inventory, Redshift, and Superset-backed reporting workflows.
- EMR Migration and Data Platform Modernization - helped move Spark/HDP workloads from EC2-based infrastructure to managed Amazon EMR with Terraform-backed provisioning and Jenkins deployment support.
- Secure GenAI Deployment Lab - built GovernAI, an on-prem AI platform using Ollama, Open WebUI, Docker, Windows Server, host firewall controls, RBAC concepts, and network behavior validation.

EDUCATION

- University of Washington - Master of Cybersecurity & Leadership — Expected June 2026 | GPA: 3.99 | Beta Gamma Sigma | Upsilon Pi Epsilon
- Ghulam Ishaq Khan Institute of Engineering Sciences and Technology - B.S. Computer Science, 2019

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate
- Oracle Cloud Infrastructure Architect - Professional
- Oracle Cloud Infrastructure Developer - Associate
- Foundations for Cybersecurity Analytics - University of Washington

HONORS

- Top Performer Award, Harri - 2023 and 2024
- Best Team Award, Systems Limited - 2020
- 1st Position Final Year Project, LifeTrack - GIKI

PUBLICATIONS AND WRITING

- Co-author, "Are You Aware of Shadow AI? GovernAI for Addressing Emerging Risks" - accepted for IEEE Silicon Valley Cybersecurity Conference (SVCC) 2026.
- Author, "Building the future with AI: Purple UW students join forces with UW-IT to shape next-gen AI" - The Tacoma Ledger, Oct. 13, 2025.